04-08 第二篇

The Sweet History of Chocolate

When you bite into a bar of chocolate today, you are enjoying a treat that has traveled a long and surprising path through history. Chocolate comes from the cacao tree, which grows in tropical regions such as Central America and West Africa. [1] The fruit of this tree, called cacao pods, contains beans that are dried, roasted, and ground into what we know as cocoa. Without these beans, there would be no chocolate at all—no bars, no hot drinks, and no desserts.

The story of chocolate begins thousands of years ago. [2] The ancient Maya and Aztec peoples of Mesoamerica were among the first to use cacao. They did not eat sweet chocolate bars; instead, they drank a bitter, spicy beverage made from ground cacao beans mixed with water and chili peppers. This drink was so valued that cacao beans were sometimes used as money. Rulers and warriors drank it during important ceremonies.

For a long time, chocolate stayed in the Americas. [3] Everything changed when Spanish explorers brought cacao beans back to Europe in the 1500s. At first, only the wealthy could afford it. European cooks began to add sugar and honey to the bitter drink, turning it into something sweeter and more popular. Over time, chocolate houses opened in cities like London, and drinking chocolate became a fashionable custom among the rich.

The way we enjoy chocolate today took shape in the 1800s. [4] In 1847, a British company learned how to blend cocoa butter with cocoa powder and sugar to create a solid bar. This invention made it possible to eat chocolate instead of only drinking it. Soon, milk chocolate was developed by adding milk powder, and factories began to produce chocolate in large quantities. For the first time, ordinary people could buy and enjoy chocolate as an everyday treat.

[5] From an ancient bitter drink to a worldwide favorite, chocolate has come a long way. Today, millions of people around the globe enjoy it in countless forms—whether as a simple snack, a gift, or a special dessert. The next time you taste chocolate, remember that you are sharing in a tradition that spans cultures and centuries.

选项

A. It was not until the Age of Exploration that chocolate reached other parts of the world. B. In the end, chocolate has grown from a local secret to a global delight. C. Inside the fruit of this tree grow the seeds that form the basis of every chocolate product we enjoy. D. These early civilizations discovered cacao and created the first chocolate-like drinks.

E. That changed when inventors found new ways to process and shape chocolate. F. Cocoa beans were so precious that they were even used in religious and royal rituals.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] C [2] D [3] A [4] E [5] B

深度解析

- **[1] C**：
  - **线索**：可可豆介绍与语义衔接。空前描述"cacao tree...grows in tropical regions"，空后"The fruit of this tree, called cacao pods, contains beans that are dried, roasted, and ground into...cocoa"。C选项"Inside the fruit of this tree grow the seeds that form the basis of every chocolate product we enjoy"（这棵树的果实内生长的种子构成了我们所享用的每一种巧克力产品的基础）中"the fruit of this tree"与空后"The fruit of this tree, called cacao pods"自然衔接，"seeds"与"beans"同指，"basis of every chocolate product"与"dried, roasted, and ground into cocoa"及"no chocolate at all"形成因果呼应，逻辑顺畅。
- **[2] D**：
  - **线索**：历史追溯与例证引入。空前指出"The story of chocolate begins thousands of years ago"，空后具体描述"The ancient Maya and Aztec peoples...were among the first to use cacao...drank a bitter, spicy beverage"。D选项"These early civilizations discovered cacao and created the first chocolate-like drinks"（这些早期文明发现了可可并创造了最早的类巧克力饮品）中"These early civilizations"自然引出空后"Maya and Aztec"，"first chocolate-like drinks"与"bitter, spicy beverage made from ground cacao beans"完美对应，逻辑顺畅。
- **[3] A**：
  - **线索**：地理转折与时代引入。空前指出"For a long time, chocolate stayed in the Americas"，空后"Everything changed when Spanish explorers brought cacao beans back to Europe in the 1500s"。A选项"It was not until the Age of Exploration that chocolate reached other parts of the world"（直到大航海时代，巧克力才传播到世界其他地区）中"It was not until"与空前"stayed in the Americas"形成转折，"Age of Exploration"与空后"Spanish explorers...1500s"时代对应，"reached other parts of the world"与"brought...back to Europe"呼应，衔接紧密。
- **[4] E**：

- **线索**：技术创新与具体展开。空前指出"The way we enjoy chocolate today took shape in the 1800s"，空后具体描述"In 1847...learned how to blend...to create a solid bar...milk chocolate was developed...factories began to produce...ordinary people could buy"。E选项"That changed when inventors found new ways to process and shape chocolate"（当发明家找到加工和塑造巧克力的新方法时，情况发生了变化）中"That changed"承接"took shape"的转折，"new ways to process and shape"与空后"blend...create a solid bar...milk chocolate...produce in large quantities"完美对应，引出具体发明。

- **[5] B**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后"From an ancient bitter drink to a worldwide favorite...Today, millions of people...enjoy it...sharing in a tradition that spans cultures and centuries"。B选项"In the end, chocolate has grown from a local secret to a global delight"（总之，巧克力已从一种地方秘密发展为全球喜爱之物）用"In the end"总结，"local secret"对应"ancient...Americas"，"global delight"与"worldwide favorite...millions of people around the globe"呼应，升华得当。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Cocoa beans were so precious that they were even used in religious and royal rituals.**：提及可可豆的珍贵及在宗教与皇家仪式中的用途，与空[2]前后"Maya and Aztec...valued...important ceremonies"高度相关，易被误选。但空[2]空前为"The story of chocolate begins thousands of years ago"，空后需先引出"谁最早使用可可"，再展开具体用途。D用"These early civilizations discovered cacao and created the first chocolate-like drinks"完成"引入主体+概括贡献"的角色；F若填入，则前文缺少对"Maya and Aztec"的引入，且"religious and royal rituals"与空后"Rulers and warriors drank it during important ceremonies"有重叠但F更侧重"precious...used as"，而空后重点在"bitter beverage...chili peppers...used as money"。D的"discovered...created first drinks"与空后"did not eat sweet bars...drank bitter beverage"的对比衔接更自然。F属"语义相近但衔接顺序不当"型干扰。